

INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

LAW



FOR ADDITIONAL
INFORMATION SCAN
THE CODE

WHAT IS THE FIELD OF LAW?

When students think about lawyers, often images from television and movies come to mind, where lawyers are standing up in courtrooms either defending accused individuals or prosecuting the “bad guys” to fight for justice. In reality, only a small percentage of lawyers actually go to trial, and an even smaller percentage get to work on glamorous or high-profile cases. The field of law is vast, and there are numerous specialized occupations with distinct roles and responsibilities. In general, the legal profession can be divided into two major categories: litigations and transactions. Litigation is the process of arguing a dispute between two parties, while transactions relate to business and personal matters that usually do not require going to court. Specializations exist within both areas, and include tax, antitrust, bankruptcy, labor, real estate, insurance, international trade, intellectual property, employment, environmental regulation, and mergers and acquisitions—to name just a few. Lawyers can also specialize in specific industries such as health care, high tech, life sciences, entertainment, or nonprofits.

OUTLOOK

Despite many recent challenges, the U.S. Department of Labor predicts that “demand for legal work will continue as individuals, businesses, and all levels of government will need legal services in many areas.” Employment is expected to grow by 6% through 2028. More than 1.3 million lawyers were employed in the United States according to the American Bar Association (ABA). The total number of legal professionals (including paralegals, legal secretaries, judges, law professors, law firm managers, etc.) is probably 2.1 million or higher.

Morkes, Andrew. *Vault Career Guide to Law Jobs, Third Edition*. Vault, 2021, *Vault Guides*, access.vault.com/vault-guides

SALARY EXPECTATIONS

Median pay: \$126,930 per year

A JD is required to become a practicing lawyer.

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, U.S. Department of Labor, Occupational Outlook Handbook, Lawyers, bit.ly/35uj5kj

SKILLS AND ABILITIES

- Ability to withstand long hours
- Creativity
- Critical thinking
- Juris Doctor degree
- Perseverance
- Reasoning ability
- Research abilities
- Strong written and oral communication



Yeshiva University

SHEVET GLAUBACH CENTER FOR CAREER
STRATEGY AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

CAREER TRACKS

Law careers can consist of many different tracks:

- Assistant District Attorneys
- Firm Associates
- In-House Counsel
- Judges
- Law Professors
- Paralegals
- Public Interest Attorneys
- Trial Lawyers

Entry level titles within this industry include:

- File Clerk
- Legal Assistant

KEY RESUME SEARCH TERMS (SEO)

- Adjudication
- Affidavits
- Briefs
- Case Law
- Conflict Resolution
- Criminology
- Defense
- Deposition
- Due Diligence
- Legal Research
- Legal Writing
- Litigation
- Mediation
- Probate
- Settlement
- Trial Preparation

Using statements of accomplishment on your resume is the most effective way to demonstrate your skills and leverage resume buzzwords.

Rank higher in the system or in a recruiter's search results by matching your resume keywords to exactly what's in the job description.

CAREER RESOURCES

- [Idealist](#)
- [Martindale](#)
- [NALP Directory of Legal Employers](#)
- [Firsthand](#)

PROFESSIONAL NETWORKING ORGANIZATIONS

- [American Bar Association](#)
- [National Association for Law Placement](#)
- [National Federation of Paralegal Associations](#)
- [New York City Bar](#)